Understanding Phentermine

Schedule IV Rx Brand Names: Adipex-P · Lomaira · Suprenza · (also in Qsymia combination)

WHAT IS PHENTERMINE?

How It Works
Stimulates brain chemicals (norepinephrine) to suppress appetite — makes you feel full faster and eat less

Classification
"Anorectic" or "anorexiant" — DEA Schedule IV controlled substance. Approved for **short-term use (up to 12 weeks)**

Who Can Use It
Adults with BMI ≥30 kg/m², or BMI ≥27 kg/m² with weight-related health conditions (diabetes, high BP, high cholesterol)

Dosing
15–37.5 mg orally every morning, before breakfast or 1–2 hours after. Max: 37.5 mg/day. Age ≥16 for obesity.

SIDE EFFECTS

Common Side Effects

- Dry mouth, unpleasant taste
- Diarrhea or constipation
- Nausea or vomiting
- Increased heart rate
- Nervousness, restlessness
- Insomnia (take in AM to reduce)
- Headache

Serious Side Effects — Seek Care Immediately

- URGENT High blood pressure spike
- URGENT Chest pain or shortness of breath
- URGENT Heart palpitations or irregular heartbeat
- URGENT Tremors or seizures
- URGENT Severe restlessness or agitation

DO NOT USE IF YOU HAVE:

- CI History of heart disease, stroke, or arrhythmia
- CI Uncontrolled high blood pressure
- CI Glaucoma
- CI Overactive thyroid (hyperthyroidism)
- CI History of drug abuse or addiction
- CI Agitated states or anxiety disorders
- CI Taking or recently took MAO inhibitors (within 14 days)
- CI Pregnancy or nursing mothers
- CI Renal failure or seizure disorder

DRUG INTERACTIONS — TELL YOUR DOCTOR

- MAO inhibitors — dangerous, potentially fatal combination
- Other sympathomimetics — compounding stimulant effects
- Insulin / oral diabetes medications — may need dose reduction
- Alcohol — avoid; increases side effects
- Anesthetic agents — inform surgeon before any procedure
- Blood pressure medications — may reduce their effectiveness

Tolerance Note
If you notice phentermine becoming less effective over time, contact our office. Do not increase the dose on your own — the medication should be tapered gradually when stopping.

Phentermine Is a Tool — Not the Whole Plan

Phentermine works **best** alongside a reduced-calorie diet, regular physical activity, and behavioral changes. It is intended for **short-term use** to jumpstart your weight loss journey. Your follow-up appointments are essential to monitor your blood pressure, heart rate, and progress. Questions? Call us anytime at **(281) 557-0300**.